

Auwa — Priority To-Do

Last revised: 23 July 2026. The single current list of what Tom and Rieko are focused on.

Strategy and the "why" live in `arrival.md` ; this is the "what next", and it churns weekly.

*Owners: (T) Tom / Hanmoto, (R) Rieko / Eshi, (T+R) both. PDF export: `documents/Auwa-
Todo.pdf` .*

Deadlines — don't let these slip

- **Trademarks: pay WIPO from More Air before 15 Aug 2026.** (T) Madrid Protocol filing. Hard external deadline, irreversible if missed. (see `structure.md`)
 - **~3 Sep 2026: design mark UK opposition window closes.** (T) Diarise only. No action unless the UK IPO writes to you.
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The theme for the coming weeks: fix capture, then pour fuel on it

Audience growth is fine (2,667 followers). The gap is capture: ~93 subscribers, and there is now live ad spend pushing leads into a funnel that isn't fully built. Order of operations: make capture work end-to-end (near-zero cost), then scale Meta spend into a funnel that converts. Do it in that order and £1,800 of ads does the work of £4,000. Sections 1–4 are the capture engine; 5+ are the parallel craft and activation tracks.

1. Quiet Letter live + bank the leads we're already buying — TOP PRIORITY (T; R for art)

The bottleneck. It unblocks three things at once: measuring ad-lead quality, stopping the existing list decaying, and banking the leads the ad is buying right now.

- Deploy the Quiet Letter template + route (`/marketing:quiet-letter`); drop Rieko's season illustrations into `website/main/public/email/seasons/` and deploy so they're publicly reachable. (R art, T deploy)
- Test send to Tom's own inbox first.

- **Send one warm Quiet Letter to the existing ~93 subscribers before the list grows further**, so it doesn't go cold. Time-boxed: the ad is adding names daily.
- Retrieve the Meta lead-form leads → Resend (tag **Store Waitlist**); set up the Google-Sheets auto-delivery so it isn't a manual CSV each time.
- (see `newsletter.md`; `instagram.md` capture loop)

2. Meta ad campaign — run the loop, don't scale yet (T)

- Ad A (live since 22 Jul: animation reel + Instant Form): **leave untouched until ~27 Jul**. Day-1 = 5 leads @ £0.94, under the £2 gate. Judge on the full-run cost-per-lead, then on lead *quality* once the Quiet Letter is sending.
- Then launch **Ad B** (same reel, combined-offer form) and **Ad C** (store-tailored video, same offer) together. Cut a **10–15s video** for these — the 47s film loses almost everyone by 0:10.
- **Do not raise budget until the capture funnel + Quiet Letter are live**. The ad money is already proven; the constraint is the funnel, not the budget.
- (see `instagram.md` "Meta lead ads" + Day-1 result)

3. Capture destination — the free, highest-leverage fix (T)

Meta cheaply carries people to the profile; the leak is where they land.

- Point the **IG bio link at a dedicated signup/giveaway page** that leads with the figure giveaway. Fix the destination, not the beautiful post sending people there.
- Use the **Stories link sticker** (any account, no boost needed) as the most direct IG→web path.
- Put the **hard giveaway CTA on the figure posts** (buying / entering headspace); keep the animation as the awareness engine (world-and-wonder headspace). One purpose-built giveaway post that borrows the hero animation's visual language, boosted for signups, is effectively Ad C's creative.
- Launch the giveaway to select subscribers: soft mention in the caption, bio + link pointing straight at signup. The clickable button just needs the free business account you already have; there's no paid tier to buy. (Auwa-Instagram, Auwa-Arrival)

4. Journal SEO optimisation — compounding organic capture (T; R writes)

High-intent strangers already land on the articles from search; a page that ranks but doesn't capture leaks the best free traffic Auwa gets.

- Run **/journal:optimise** across published articles, most-visited first: pull Google Search Console near-miss queries (position ~8–20 with real impressions), tighten meta titles/descriptions, add sibling internal links, sharpen image alt text, confirm the signup card sits well in-context. Never sacrifice prose quality for keywords.
- **Re-request indexing** for each changed URL in GSC and resubmit the sitemap, so new titles show in results in days, not weeks.
- Keep publishing new articles at ~1/month (Rieko writes; each also yields one IG slideshow). (see `journal.md` Section 8)

5. App — finish and put in friends' hands (T)

Very close, likely next week. Finish the remaining pieces, share the `auwa.app` link with friends via WhatsApp, gather feedback, then package for the app stores with Capacitor (the native container step). Free tier only; not a public moment. (Auwa-App)

6. Connections / warm activation (T lead; R for Japan)

The grid is full now, so these are no longer gated on the profile.

- **Colin** — both books; his publisher-route view is the tiebreaker on the print decision (item 8).
- **LinkedIn update** — warm, proud, no ask (restart template in `arrival.md`).
- **Fin DAC** — publish the drafted Fin article first, then send it to him as the warm reconnection; the collab conversation follows naturally.
- **Kyoto knife shop** (R, in Japanese) — email the shop where Tom bought the Shigefusa knife, sharing the article as a Japanese-translated PDF with photos, in the hope it reaches Shigefusa. (Auwa-Arrival)

7. Distribution / backlinks (T)

- Free design showcases: SiteInspire, CSS Design Awards, Typewolf, Godly, Minimal.gallery, httpster.
- Aligned sites for backlinks + quiet intros: Nalata Nalata, Analogue Life, Rikumo, Tortoise, Kinto, Ignant, Remodelista, Freunde von Freunden, Hole & Corner, Kyoto Journal, Tofugu. (Auwa-Arrival)

8. Book — decide the print route (T; Colin input)

Review the test prints and decide: Amazon KDP, or IngramSpark POD plus a pre-order-funded offset first edition, or approaching publishers. Colin's view is the tiebreaker. Compare pros and cons before committing. (Auwa-Book)

9. Figure — bio-filament, finishing, packaging, price (R design; T ops)

Test the bio filament, refine the figure and finishing method, finalise packaging (balsa box, ribbon, eco insert, handwritten card) and pricing. The autumn figure drop is the year's first commercial moment, and it needs the warm list (sections 1–4) ready before it. (Auwa-Business)

10. Store — basic Shopify (T)

Set up a standard Shopify + Stripe store (not the old multi-vendor model) to sell the book and figure, linked from auwa.life and Instagram. (Auwa-Business)

Upkeep: regenerate this list at the top of a working session ("update the todo") — re-sort by current priority, fold in anything new, then re-export `documents/Auwa-Todo.pdf` via the `pdf.md` pipeline. Keep strategy changes in `arrival.md` ; keep only the actionable "what next" here.